

METHODOLOGY

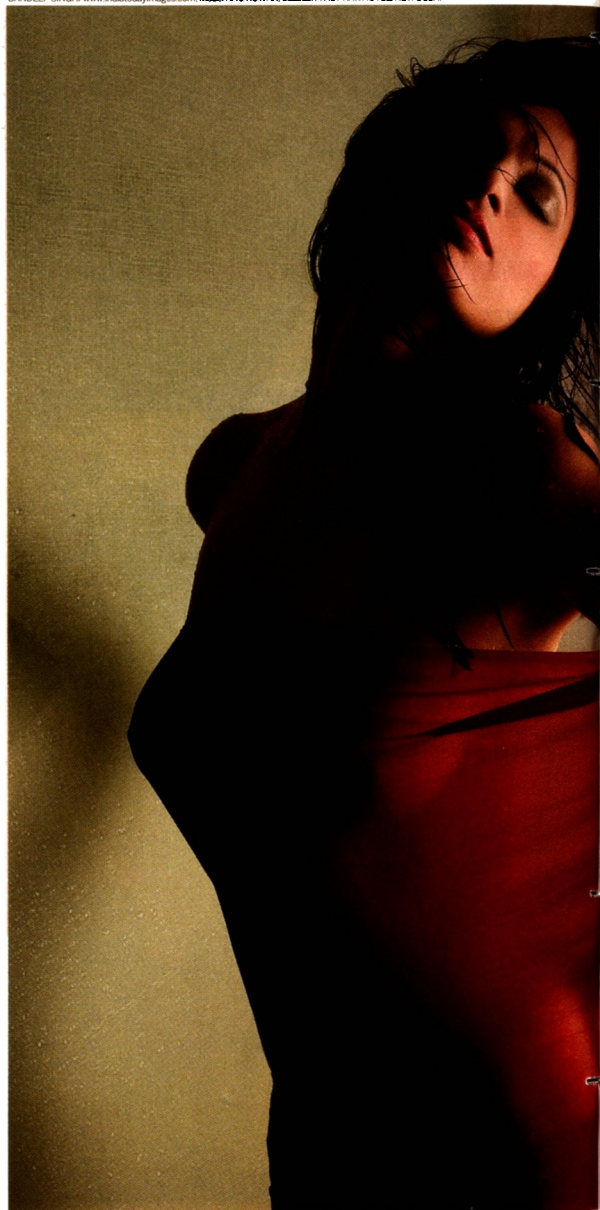
The INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG MARG Sex Survey 2009 was carried out to understand the different facets of sexuality of single and married men and women. The survey, INDIA TODAY's seventh was conducted among men and women of five age groups, 18-25 years, 26-34 years, 35-40 years, 41-50 years and 51-60 years. They belonged to the middle and upper middle-class and lower middle-class (Sec A, B and C).

In this year's survey, the main emphasis was on sexual fantasies and desires. The survey classified fantasy into two parts, one being the kind of fantasy one would want to harbour but not something one would want to do and other is the one practices. The survey had a sample size of 5,371 respondents across 11 cities: Delhi, Chennai, Hyderabad, Ahmedabad, Patna, Mumbai, Bangalore, Lucknow, Jaipur, Ludhiana and Kolkata. The respondents were divided in terms of their gender: there were 2,704 males and 2,667 females. The study was split in two phases. In the first phase, recruitment interviews were done where respondents were asked basic questions regarding their demographics and their consent was taken to participate in the survey on the condition of anonymity. This was followed by the second phase in which they were asked to complete a self-administered questionnaire. The survey tried to use interviewers who had experience in handling such sensitive issues. In most cases, the same teams which conducted the earlier sex surveys were given the task. To protect the identity of the respondents, a ballot box was kept at the venue where each respondent would drop the questionnaire filled by him/her without their name or contact details. Given that the questionnaire contained a number of sensitive issues, some respondents chose not to reply to a few questions.

all her efforts to woo Rama. So while only 14 per cent of the women fantasised about sex with a stranger, the number for men is 53 per cent.

Safety seems the prime concern for women, whether it is in their favourite fantasy form of sex, oral sex; or the favoured place of sex, the bedroom; or even the favourite fantasy position, the missionary position. The articulation of female desire is still in the realm of silence with 70 per cent of the women not even sharing their sexual fantasies with their partners. For men though, risky behaviour in thought and action seems second nature. So whether it is men between 26 and 34 who want oral sex with girls less than 18 or men between 51 and 60 who want to sleep with women between 31 and 40, it seems age is not a barrier for them. At least 28 per cent married men have had sex outside marriage and 44 per cent have made an MMS of themselves while having sex, showing a strong streak of exhibitionism. But basic fantasies have not altered—rather stereotypes have been reinforced. While 45 per cent Indian men want to have

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sex with village women, suggesting a sense of nostalgia, several men believe that Muslims (20 per cent) and Punjabis (14 per cent) are more attractive sexually.

Psychiatrist Anurag Mishra says the expansion of visual porn may well be responsible for finessing techniques but diminishing the repertoire for men. It may also be inhibiting the women, who, faced with a world where they are expected to be sexual goddesses, flee from being too expres-